全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 13 單元 | 商業與經濟 · Business & Economy

From Night Market Stall to Stock Market

從夜市攤位到股票市場

TAICHUNG, Nov. 2 — Twelve years ago, brothers Chen Wei-ting and Chen Wei-lun were selling brown sugar milk tea from a tiny stall at Fengjia Night Market. Today their company, Sugar Bear, has 140 shops across Asia, and on Monday its stock was traded on the Taipei exchange for the first time.

The founders say the secret was never the tea itself. "Every stall in Taichung sells good tea," Wei-ting told reporters. "What we built was a brand." In 2016, the brothers registered a trademark, hired a small agency to advertise on social media, and began to manufacture their own cups instead of buying them from a supplier. These strategies made Sugar Bear more competitive, and demand grew so quickly that the shop was often sold out by 8 p.m.

The road was not always smooth. During the 2020 recession, consumers stayed home, and the company nearly went bankrupt. An investor from Singapore agreed to provide funds, but only after weeks of negotiation. "We had to negotiate every detail, from profit sharing to who would pay the taxes," Wei-lun recalled. The venture survived, and when the economy recovered, Sugar Bear was ready to expand.

Economists say the story reflects a wider change in Taiwan, where small family enterprises are increasingly being turned into modern corporations. The company now sponsors a youth basketball league, and the brothers insist that profit matters less than people. "Our first client was a tired student who wanted something sweet after cram school," Wei-ting said. "We still make the tea for her."

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
brand	*n.*	品牌	This brand of sneakers is popular with teenagers. 這個運動鞋品牌很受青少年歡迎。

trademark	*n.*	商標	The company's trademark is a small blue bird. 這家公司的商標是一隻小藍鳥。
advertise	*v.*	登廣告；宣傳	The store advertised its sale in the newspaper. 這家店在報紙上刊登特賣廣告。
manufacture	*v.*	製造	The factory manufactures bicycles for export. 這家工廠製造外銷用的腳踏車。
competitive	*adj.*	有競爭力的；競爭激烈的	The price of this laptop is very competitive. 這台筆電的價格很有競爭力。
demand	*n.*	需求	There is a high demand for electric scooters in Taiwan. 台灣對電動機車的需求很高。
recession	*n.*	經濟衰退	Many people lost their jobs during the recession. 經濟衰退期間許多人失業。
consumer	*n.*	消費者	Consumers are paying more attention to food safety. 消費者越來越重視食品安全。
bankrupt	*adj.*	破產的	The airline went bankrupt after the pandemic. 這家航空公司在疫情後破產了。
negotiate	*v.*	談判；協商	The workers negotiated with the company for higher pay. 工人與公司協商以爭取更高的薪資。

片語 Phrases

for the first time	第一次	I rode the high-speed rail for the first time last year. 我去年第一次搭高鐵。
be sold out	賣完；售罄	The concert tickets were sold out in ten minutes. 演唱會門票十分鐘內就賣完了。
be ready to + V	準備好做…	After months of practice, the team was ready to compete. 經過幾個月的練習，球隊已準備好參賽。

文法與句型 Grammar

S＋V＋so＋adj./adv.＋that＋S＋V

「如此…以致於…」，so 後接形容詞或副詞，that 子句說明結果。文章第二段：demand grew so quickly that the shop was often sold out by 8 p.m.

The movie was so boring that half the audience fell asleep.

這部電影無聊到一半的觀眾都睡著了。

N（地方）, where＋S＋V

關係副詞 where 引導的非限定關係子句，用來補充說明前面的地方名詞，相當於 in which。文章第四段：a wider change in Taiwan, where small family enterprises are...

We visited Lukang, where many old temples still stand.

我們造訪了鹿港，那裡還保留著許多古老的廟宇。

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